

First Volo Morphology

Grades 6-8 Morphology Progress Monitoring Probe

Educator Guide

Purpose

A brief, informal progress-monitoring measure of students' knowledge of Greek and Latin roots and affixes and their ability to use morphology to analyze and infer the meanings of unfamiliar academic words. Forms A and B are parallel forms that may be alternated across administrations to monitor change over time. This is not a standardized assessment or an official Common Core assessment.

Administration

- Directions, target words, sentences, and answer choices may be read aloud.
- Do not define a target word, identify its parts, or tell the student what a morpheme means during scored items.
- Repeat directions if needed without teaching the answer.
- **Record the student and educator information appropriate for your setting and follow local school or district privacy procedures.**
- **Teach the target morphemes during instruction, but avoid direct teaching of the exact probe words between administrations when possible so transfer can be evaluated.**

Transfer Word Note

The transfer items use whole words that should remain unfamiliar when possible. Avoid directly teaching the exact probe words before the next administration; teaching the same morphemes in other words is encouraged.

CCSS Skills Sampled

Standard	Skill sampled
L.6.4a / L.7.4a / L.8.4a	Use context as a clue to the meaning of a word or phrase.
L.6.4b / L.7.4b / L.8.4b	Use common, grade-appropriate Greek or Latin affixes and roots as clues to word meaning.

Primary construct: independent morphological meaning inference under L.6.4b, L.7.4b, and L.8.4b. The decomposition and word-building items are supporting measures of morphological analysis rather than separate CCSS standards. Because words may be read aloud, this probe should not be interpreted as an independent decoding measure.

Grades 6-8 Morphology Probe

Form A

Student:

Educator:

Grade:

Date:

Form: A

Directions: Use what you know about meaningful word parts. If you are not sure, choose the answer that makes the most sense.

Part 1 - Know the Word Parts

1. What does spect usually mean?

- A. look or watch
- B. break
- C. carry

2. What does struct usually mean?

- A. send
- B. build
- C. say

3. What does inter- usually mean?

- A. under
- B. between or among
- C. against

4. What does -ive usually mean?

- A. having a quality or tending to
- B. without
- C. before

Part 2 - Break It Apart

5. Break inspection into its meaningful parts.

6. Break constructive into its meaningful parts.

Part 3 - Figure Out New Words

7. What does interregional probably mean?

- A. between or involving regions
- B. below a region
- C. against a region

8. What does substructure probably mean?

- A. a structure below or supporting another structure
- B. a structure built again
- C. a structure across a distance

9. What does reconstructive probably mean?

- A. having to do with building or restoring again
- B. having to do with looking between things
- C. having no structure

Grades 6-8 Morphology Probe

Form A - continued

Student:

Educator:

Grade:

Date:

Form: A

Part 4 - Use Word Parts and Context

10. Read or listen:

At the end of the year, the class created a retrospective display that looked back at important events from the past.

What does retrospective probably mean?

- A. looking back at the past
- B. looking between two objects
- C. building something again

Part 5 - Build a Word

11. Combine inter- + act + -ive. What word do you make?

What does the word mean?

Part 6 - Explain Your Thinking

12. Engineers designed a subterranean passage beneath the city streets. What does subterranean probably mean?

How did one or more word parts help you figure it out?

Educator Score

Morpheme knowledge /4	Structural analysis /2	Independent transfer /3	Total /12
Morphology + context /1	Word construction /1	Reasoning /1	

Grades 6-8 Morphology Probe

Form B

Student:

Educator:

Grade:

Date:

Form: B

Directions: Use what you know about meaningful word parts. If you are not sure, choose the answer that makes the most sense.

Part 1 - Know the Word Parts

1. What does spect usually mean?

- A. carry
- B. look or watch
- C. send

2. What does struct usually mean?

- A. build
- B. hear
- C. follow

3. What does inter- usually mean?

- A. against
- B. before
- C. between or among

4. What does -ive usually mean?

- A. without
- B. having a quality or tending to
- C. person who

Part 2 - Break It Apart

5. Break inspector into its meaningful parts.

6. Break destructive into its meaningful parts.

Part 3 - Figure Out New Words

7. What does interdepartmental probably mean?

- A. within one department only
- B. between or involving departments
- C. against all departments

8. What does transcontinental probably mean?

- A. across a continent
- B. under a continent
- C. before a continent

9. What does disruptive probably mean?

- A. tending to break apart or interrupt
- B. tending to build carefully
- C. able to look closely

Grades 6-8 Morphology Probe

Form B - continued

Student:

Educator:

Grade:

Date:

Form: B

Part 4 - Use Word Parts and Context

10. Read or listen:

Kai misinterpreted the directions and completed the wrong section of the assignment.

What does misinterpreted probably mean?

- A. understood incorrectly
- B. understood in advance
- C. understood together with someone

Part 5 - Build a Word

11. Combine pre- + dict + -ive. What word do you make?

What does the word mean?

Part 6 - Explain Your Thinking

12. The chemical reaction was irreversible, so the materials could not be changed back to their original form. What does irreversible probably mean?

How did one or more word parts help you figure it out?

Educator Score

Morpheme knowledge /4	Structural analysis /2	Independent transfer /3	Total /12
Morphology + context /1	Word construction /1	Reasoning /1	

Educator Scoring & Standards Map

Grades 6-8 Forms A and B

Give 1 point per item. For Item 11, require both the correctly formed word and an essentially correct meaning. For Item 12, require both an essentially correct whole-word interpretation and a reasonable explanation connecting one or more meaningful word parts to the interpretation.

#	Skill	Form A / Form B answer	CCSS	Alignment
1	Latin root meaning	spect = look/watch	L.6.4b; L.7.4b; L.8.4b	Direct
2	Latin root meaning	struct = build	L.6.4b; L.7.4b; L.8.4b	Direct
3	Latin prefix meaning	inter- = between/among	L.6.4b; L.7.4b; L.8.4b	Direct
4	Derivational suffix meaning	-ive = having a quality/tending to	L.6.4b; L.7.4b; L.8.4b	Direct
5	Analyze prefix + root + suffix	in + spect + ion / in + spect + or	L.6/7/8.4b	Supporting analysis measure
6	Analyze multi-part word	con + struct + ive / de + struct + ive	L.6/7/8.4b	Supporting analysis measure
7	Independent affix transfer	between regions / between departments	L.6.4b; L.7.4b; L.8.4b	Direct
8	Independent morphology transfer	structure below/supporting / across a continent	L.6.4b; L.7.4b; L.8.4b	Direct
9	Multi-part morphology transfer	building/restoring again / tending to interrupt or break apart	L.6.4b; L.7.4b; L.8.4b	Direct
10	Morphology + context	looking back at past / understood incorrectly	L.6/7/8.4a-b	Direct/combined strategy
11	Construct + interpret a word	interactive / predictive	L.6/7/8.4b	Supporting constructed response
12	Infer + explain morphology	underground/beneath earth / cannot be reversed	L.6/7/8.4a-b	Direct skill + explanation

Item 11 Meaning Criteria

Accept conceptually accurate meanings

Form A interactive: involving action or exchange between people or things. Form B predictive: having to do with predicting or indicating what is likely to happen. Do not require students to reproduce a dictionary definition.

Optional Mediated Probe - Do Not Add to /12 Score

After the independent response is recorded

If a student misses Items 7-10 or 12, the educator may then provide the relevant morpheme meaning(s) and ask again. Record only whether the student becomes correct after the cue. This helps distinguish morpheme-meaning knowledge from the ability to apply a supplied morphological clue.

Progress Monitoring Record

Grades 6-8 First Volo Morphology

Use one record per student. Record and store student information according to your school or district procedures.

Student: _____	Educator: _____
Grade: _____	Date range: _____
Administration 1 Form: _____	Administration 2 Form: _____
Number of First Volo sessions: _____	Approx. total minutes: _____
Word-part study set(s): _____	Activities used: _____

Progress Monitoring Scores

Measure	Initial	Follow-Up	Change	Notes
Morpheme knowledge /4				
Structural analysis /2				
Independent transfer /3				
Morphology + context /1				
Word construction /1				
Explicit reasoning /1				
Total /12				

Engagement & Independence

Rating	1	2	3	4
Engagement	Frequently disengaged	Repeated prompting	Generally engaged	Highly engaged
Independence	Substantial support	Frequent support	Occasional support	Independent

Would the student choose to use it again? Yes / Maybe / No

Would you use this resource again with students? Yes / Maybe / No

Qualitative Observation

Record one example of something the student said or did that showed how they were thinking about a word.
